
OPERATIONS GUIDE

How Eswachh works, end to end

Everything the platform does today, who can do it, what runs by itself overnight, and what is built but deliberately switched off.

FOR	Owners, administrators, and anyone explaining the system to a client
COVERS	The public site, the office, the customer portal and the cleaner's round
COMPANION	developer-guide.pdf, for how any of it is changed
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The shape of the thing

- 1.1 There is one system and one database. What changes is which door you came in through, and each door shows a different building.

DOOR	ADDRESS	WHO USES IT
The public site	/	Anybody. Prices, packages, advice articles, the team, questions, contact, and the signup and renewal forms.
The office	/app	Administrators, franchise owners and cleaners. Everything operational.
A customer's account	/my	Customers only. Their cars, their money, their complaints.

Signing in at `/login` sends a person to whichever of the last two is theirs. Nobody chooses; the role decides. A customer who reaches an office address is returned to their own pages, and the reverse is also true.

1.2

Franchises

The business is divided into **branches**, and every branch owns a set of **sectors** — the societies and neighbourhoods it services. A franchise owner sees their branch and nothing else: not another franchise's customers, not their payments, not their complaints, not even the fact that they exist. Asking for a record that belongs to another branch produces the same answer as asking for one that was never created.

A franchise with several sectors needs no special treatment. Sectors are assigned to a branch, so a franchise covering four societies simply has four sectors attached. That assignment is made by an administrator, on the sector record itself.

Only an **administrator** sees across every branch, and there is a branch selector in the top bar for switching between them.

What a customer can do

- 2.1 Four things, and they are the four the requirements document asks for. Everything else on the public site is reading material.

CHOICE	WHAT IT DOES	STATUS
Subscribe	A new customer takes out a plan on a car.	LIVE
Renew	An existing customer extends a plan that is running out, by car number.	LIVE
Cloth top-up	Buys more ironing cloths against a running plan.	HIDDEN
Raise a complaint	Reports a problem, which reaches the cleaner the same minute.	LIVE

ON THE CLOTH SERVICE

It is built, tested and working on both sides — the customer's top-up page, the cleaner's pickup and delivery screens, the balance ledger and the low-balance warning. It is switched off business-wide while the business decides whether to run it. Section 09 covers what turning it on involves.

2.2

Subscribing, step by step

- 01 **They enter their mobile number** and we send a code to it. Nothing is created yet.
- 02 **The code proves the number.** A number we already hold is turned away with an invitation to sign in — one person, one account.
- 03 **They give their details and their car:** name, address, society, car number, model, package, how much interior cleaning, and for how long.
- 04 **A price appears** as they choose. It is a quote for display only; the real figure is worked out again on our side when they pay.
- 05 **They pay.** The plan is created as *pending* and a payment record is opened before the payment window appears, so an abandoned checkout still leaves something to chase.
- 06 **The gateway confirms.** Only then does the plan become active. Two messages go out: a welcome to the customer, and an alert to the office that a new car needs a cleaner.

The new car now sits on the **unassigned** list until somebody gives it to a cleaner. That list is the first thing the office sees.

Renewing

From the public site a customer types their car number, sees the plan and what it will cost, and pays. From inside their account they press Renew on the plan itself, and — as in the previous system — may change the package, the amount of interior cleaning and the length before paying.

Changing any of those **reprices the plan before the payment window opens**. A customer who switches from one month to six is charged for six.

A renewal extends from the current end date, not from today, so renewing early never costs a customer the days they have already paid for.

Raising a complaint

A signed-in customer picks the plan, a category and a priority, and writes what is wrong. The complaint is logged against the plan, and the cleaner assigned to that car is messaged immediately. The office can hand it to somebody else, mark it resolved, and close it — though closing is treated as the customer's word to give, so a cleaner may resolve but not close.

Inside a customer's account

3.1

PAGE	WHAT IT HOLDS
My plans	Every car they have with us, what each is on, when it runs out, and the buttons to renew, add a car, or top up cloths.
My payments	Everything they have paid, with an invoice they can open and print for each one.
My complaints	What they have raised and where each one has got to.
My details	Name, address, contact number, and changing their own password.

3.2

A household with two cars

Adding a second car is done from **My plans**, not from the public signup form. The form asks only for the car and what they want done to it: the address, the society and the phone number are already known, and there is no code to wait for, because being signed in is stronger proof than a code sent to a phone.

Two refusals are deliberate, and both explain themselves:

- A car **already registered to somebody else** — checked across every franchise, because a car on another branch's books is still taken. Finding that out at the payment step would be far worse.
- A car that **already has a running plan**, which is sent to renew instead. Two live plans on one car would be billed twice and cleaned once.

WHY NOT THE PUBLIC FORM

The public signup form proves a mobile number with a code and then refuses numbers it already holds. An existing customer using it would be told their own number was taken. The account route is the only one that can work.

What a signed-in customer no longer sees

HIDDEN

The **Renew** and **Subscribe** buttons are not shown in the header to a customer who is signed in. They do both from their own pages, where their details are already filled in. Staff still see them, and the pages themselves are untouched and still reachable by address.

The office, screen by screen

- 4.1 Nobody sees all of these. The menu is filtered by what the person signed in is allowed to do, so a cleaner's menu is four items long and an administrator's is seventeen.

SCREEN	WHAT IT IS FOR	WHO SEES IT
Dashboard	Today at a glance: money taken, plans running, what is unassigned, what is overdue, what is open.	Everyone
My round	The cleaner's list of cars for today. Each is marked cleaned, skipped or not found, with a note.	Cleaners, owners, admin
Subscriptions	Every plan. Filter, search by car number, assign a cleaner, edit, renew, put on hold, act on many at once.	Owners, admin
Customers	The people. Their cars, their address, their history.	Owners, admin
Payments	Every payment with its own detail page, linked to the plan and the invoice it belongs to.	Owners, admin
Complaints	The queue. Assign, resolve, close, with the full trail of who did what.	Everyone but customers
Cloths	Balances, pickups, deliveries, top-ups.	Owners, cleaners, admin HIDDEN
Coverage	Who turned up, and which rounds went out.	Owners, admin
Messages	What has been sent and to whom, plus sending one by hand — including society by society over WhatsApp.	Owners, admin
Reports	Money, renewals, cloth balances, service history, over any period.	Owners, admin
People	Staff accounts. A franchise owner may create cleaners; only an administrator creates owners or other administrators.	Owners, admin
Masters	The price list and the geography: cities, areas, societies, sectors, car categories and models, packages, service types, durations, cloth bundles.	Admin
Blog	The advice articles on the public site, with categories, tags and comments.	Admin
Settings	Everything in section 10.	Admin
Logs	The application log, readable without a server login.	Admin
Backups	Last night's database copy, downloadable, with one on demand.	Admin
Roles	Custom roles — see section 05.	Admin only

4.2

The three lists the day starts with

The requirements document names three things the office should land on. All three exist as saved filters on the Subscriptions screen, reachable in one click from the dashboard:

- **Cars with no cleaner** — every new plan lands here until somebody is given it. This is the landing view.
- **Renewals due** — plans running out, and plans already past their date.
- **Cloths below five** — customers about to run out. **HIDDEN WITH THE CLOTH SERVICE**

Editing a plan

An administrator can edit the whole plan: the customer, the address and society, the package, service type and duration, the dates, the amount, the cleaner, the status, and the details of the payment that was taken against it (method, reference, when it was paid, a note).

TWO RULES ON THIS SCREEN

The car number can only be changed by an administrator. Everyone else sees it as fixed. A franchise owner who edits a plan and attempts to change the registration is told plainly that the change was not applied, rather than being left to assume it was.

The amount already paid is never editable. The plan's price can be corrected; what a customer actually handed over cannot be rewritten after the fact.

4.3

The cleaner's day

- 01 **My round** lists every car assigned to them with a running plan, in society order.
- 02 **Each car is marked** cleaned, skipped, or not found — with a note for anything other than cleaned.
- 03 **Marking a car cleaned messages the customer** that their car has been done today.
- 04 **Cloths are collected and returned** from the same screen, each movement messaging the customer and adjusting the balance. **HIDDEN**
- 05 **Complaints on their cars** appear in their queue, and they can mark one resolved.

Daily cleaning records are kept for **fifty days** and then removed automatically, as the requirements document asks. The nightly backup runs *before* the removal, so every deleted record is in that night's copy — a retention rule can never be the reason something is unrecoverable.

Who is allowed to do what

5.1

ROLE	SEES	CAN
Administrator	Every branch	Everything, including settings, masters, the blog, backups, roles, and changing a car number.
Franchise owner	Their branch only	Plans, customers, cars, staff, payments and receipts, the complaint queue, the round, attendance, cloths, reports. They create cleaners and customers, not owners or administrators.
Cleaner	Their branch only	Their round, what happened at each car, their own attendance, cloth movements, and resolving a complaint. They cannot close one.
Customer	Their own records only	Their plans, renewing, their payments and invoices, raising and reading their complaints, buying cloths.

Being allowed to use a feature and being allowed to see a particular record are separate questions, and the second is always answered by asking whose record it is. A customer and a franchise owner both hold "view payments"; they see entirely different payments.

5.2

Custom roles

Where the four above are not the right shape — a supervisor who runs the round but must not touch money, an office assistant who answers complaints and nothing else — an administrator can build a role on the Roles screen.

A custom role always **refines** one of the four: it starts from that role's permissions and takes things away or adds from within what that role could already do. It can never grant sight of another branch. That limit is not a setting; there is no way to express it.

Money

6.1

How a price is worked out

Exactly as in the previous system, so historic amounts still reproduce:

```
( car category + package + service type + society surcharge ) × months
- duration discount
+ cloth bundle
```

- The **car** is priced by its category, so every hatchback costs the same whatever the badge says.
- The **society surcharge** is per society, because a basement in a tower block takes longer to reach than a house on a lane.
- The **duration discount** is per duration, because committing to six months is worth something.
- The **cloth bundle** is added after the multiplication, because it is a one-off purchase and not a monthly charge.

All of these are edited on the Masters screen and take effect immediately. Withdrawing a package from sale does not break the plans already on it; those plans are flagged so somebody can move them, rather than being quietly under-priced.

6.2

THE TWO RULES THAT ARE NOT NEGOTIABLE

No price ever comes from the browser. The figure a customer sees is a quote and is thrown away; the amount charged is worked out fresh on our side at the moment of charging. The previous system accepted whatever price the browser posted back, checking only that it was at least one rupee.

Nothing is marked paid except a confirmed payment. Signup, renewal and top-up all open a payment and stop. A plan becomes active only after the gateway's signature has been verified and the gateway has confirmed what it is holding.

Cash and offline payments

A franchise owner can record a payment taken in cash. That is recording money that has already changed hands, not taking one — the amount still comes from the plan, and who recorded it is kept.

Invoices

Every payment gets a numbered invoice, printable by both the office and the customer. The prefix is a setting. The 492 payments carried over from the previous system were numbered retrospectively so none is without one.

Payments that never came back

A customer who pays and then closes the browser before being redirected back leaves a payment that looks unfinished. Every night the system asks the gateway about the last seven days of these and settles the ones that did in fact go through — before the morning's reminders go out, so nobody is chased for money they have already handed over.

Messages

- 7.1** Fifteen messages. Twelve are the ones the requirements document sets out; three more the previous system also sent for its own reasons. The wording of every one is editable in the office, and both the automatic jobs and anything sent by hand use the same edited wording.

#	MESSAGE	SENT WHEN	GOES TO
1	New plan started	A new plan is paid for	Customer
2	New plan, told the office	The same moment — a new car needs a cleaner	The office
3	Plan renewed	A renewal is paid for	Customer
4	Cloths topped up	A cloth top-up is paid for	Customer
5	Complaint raised	A customer raises a complaint	The assigned cleaner
6	Cleaner assigned	A car is given to a cleaner	Customer
7	A message of your own	Sent by hand from the Messages screen	Whoever is chosen
8	Cleaning done	A cleaner marks the car cleaned	Customer
9	Cloths collected	Cloths are picked up	Customer
10	Cloths returned	Cloths are delivered back	Customer
11	Renewal due	Nightly, as the end date approaches	Customer
11	Renewal overdue	Nightly, once the date has passed	Customer
12	Cloths running low	The balance falls below the threshold	Customer
—	Plan paused	A plan is put on hold for being unpaid	Customer
—	Payment received	A payment is confirmed	Customer

7.2

Nobody gets told the same thing twice

Reminders are kept to one per customer per day, however many times a job runs. Messages about a specific event — a car cleaned, a payment taken — are keyed to that event instead, so a household with two cars correctly gets one message for each.

The delivery switch

IMPORTANT FOR DEMONSTRATIONS

Messages only actually leave the building when the system is running as the live site *and* delivery is switched on. Anywhere else — a test copy, a demonstration, a developer's machine — every message is written to the record exactly as it would have been sent, with the reason it was held back, and nothing reaches a customer's phone.

This means a demonstration can be given against real data without a single customer being messaged, and the Messages screen will still show precisely what would have gone out.

Society by society

The Messages screen can send to everybody in a chosen society over WhatsApp — for a price change, a holiday, or a note about the water supply.

What happens overnight

8.1 Six jobs, and the order matters. Each runs on one server only and never twice at once, because an unattended job that runs twice is worse than one that does not run at all.

TIME	JOB	WHAT IT DOES, AND WHY THEN
00:10	Back up	Copies and verifies the database. First of the lot on purpose: if a later job goes wrong, this copy is from before it did. Keeps fourteen days. A failure raises an alert rather than only writing to a log.
00:20	Settle payments	Asks the gateway about the last seven days of unfinished payments. Nothing else will ever settle these; the browser that would have told us is long closed.
00:40	Clear old rounds	Removes daily cleaning records older than fifty days. After the backup, so the night's copy always contains what is about to go.
09:30	Renewal reminders	Chases plans running out and plans overdue. After settlement, so a customer who paid last night is not chased for it.
10:00	Pause the unpaid	Puts plans a week past their date on hold. Last, so it acts on a picture that settlement has corrected and the customer has already been reminded about.
Mon 06:00	Check cloth balances	Weekly, and silent unless a balance and its ledger disagree.

The grace period before pausing, and the cloth warning threshold, are both settings — see section 10.

Built, but switched off

- 9.1 Nothing here is missing or half-finished. Each is complete and tested, and hidden because the business asked for it to be. This is the section to read out when a client asks "what about...".

HIDDEN The cloth ironing service

What exists: the customer's top-up page and the top-up button on each plan; the cloth choice on the signup and renewal forms; the cleaner's pickup and delivery screens; a balance held as an append-only ledger; the below-five warning list; the low-balance message; the weekly consistency check; and cloth bundles on the price list.

What being off does: hides the top-up page, the cloth screens and the cloth choice on the forms. It does not touch a single existing balance or ledger entry.

To turn it on: Settings → Service → *Offer the cloth ironing service*. Everything resumes exactly where it left off.

HIDDEN Renew and Subscribe for signed-in customers

Not shown in the header to a customer who is already signed in, because they do both from their own pages. Staff still see them; the pages still work by address. Reversing this is a one-line change and the developer guide says where.

HIDDEN Cloth top-up in the header

Moved to sit beside the plan it tops up. Somebody thinking about cloths is looking at their car, not at a navigation bar. The page and its address are unchanged.

9.2

OFF BY DEFAULT Only administrators may change a plan

A business-wide switch, for when franchises should stop altering what customers are on. It never restricts an administrator — somebody has to be able to correct a plan, and if this locked everyone out the only way back would be the database.

There is a finer answer as well: a custom role can take plan editing away from one franchise. Use the switch when the policy is "nobody but the office, everywhere, from today", because expressing that by editing each franchise's role one at a time is how one gets missed.

OFF BY DEFAULT Live payments and live messaging

Both the payment gateway and WhatsApp delivery are switched off until the credentials are in place on the live server. This is what makes it safe to run a copy of the system against real data.

ON BY DEFAULT Let search engines list this site

On for the real site; switch it off on any staging copy, or that copy will compete with the real site for its own name in search results.

Things the requirements document asks for that are not yet built

- Choosing the number of cloths while renewing on the *public* renew page. Inside the account it is already there.
- Pending renewals and cloths-below-five as pages of their own rather than saved filters. The information is all present; only the shortcut differs.
- An "are you sure?" step before a cleaner marks a car cleaned.

What you can change yourself

- 10.1** Settings → everything below. No developer, no release, no downtime. Nothing secret lives here: gateway keys and access tokens are kept on the server, where they are not in a database copy an administrator can download.

GROUP	SETTING	DEFAULT
Business	Business name	Eswachh
	Registered name	—
	GSTIN	—
	Address	—
Contact	Phone	—
	Email	—
	WhatsApp number	—
	Office hours	9am to 6pm, Mon–Sat
Billing	Invoice prefix	ESW
	Invoice footer note	—
Service	Days overdue before pausing	7
	Warn when cloths fall below	5
	Number for new plan alerts	—
	Only administrators may change a plan	Off
	Offer the cloth ironing service	Off
Search & sharing	Page title	Eswachh · Doorstep car cleaning, every day
	Description	Set
	Keywords	Set
	Sharing image	—
	Let search engines list this site	On
Policies	Privacy policy	Written, editable
	Terms of service	Written, editable
	Cancellation and refunds	Written, editable

The three policy pages are edited with a formatting toolbar and appear in the footer of the public site. A payment gateway will not approve a business whose site cannot show them, and

a customer should not have to ask.

The search and sharing settings

These are what a search engine lists and what appears when somebody pastes a link into WhatsApp. They are written into the page by the server, not added afterwards by the browser, which is the only way a search engine reliably reads them.

Elsewhere, not in Settings

- **The home page banner** — images, headings and the button on each, managed as its own list. The image runs the full width of the page.
- **Prices and geography** — the Masters screen.
- **Message wording** — the Messages screen.
- **Advice articles, the team, and questions** — their own screens.

Keeping the data safe

11.1

Backups

Taken every night at ten past midnight, before anything else touches the database, verified after being written, and kept for fourteen days. They are listed on the Backups screen where an administrator can download one or take another on demand. A failed backup raises an alert on the bell in the top bar, because a backup quietly failing for three months is how a restore turns out to be impossible on the day it is needed.

What is kept, and for how long

RECORD	KEPT
Daily cleaning records	Fifty days, then removed automatically
Payments and invoices	Indefinitely
Plans, customers, cars	Indefinitely. Deleting hides rather than erases, so history stays intact
Messages sent	Indefinitely
Cloth ledger	Indefinitely, and never edited — corrections are new entries
Backups	Fourteen days

What a franchise cannot see

Branch separation is enforced at the point every query is made, not by remembering to filter each screen. It is closed by default: a query that has not been told which branch it belongs to returns nothing rather than everything. A record belonging to another branch produces the same response as one that does not exist, so refusing an answer never confirms that there was something to refuse.

Signing in

Every account carried over from the previous system — customers, franchises and administrators — signs in with the credentials they already had. Customers can sign in with a code sent to their phone instead. Those codes expire, and a wrong guess does not extend one.

Where to go next. Anything in this guide that needs changing — a flag flipped, wording altered, a rule adjusted — is covered in *developer-guide.pdf*, beside this file, which names the exact file and line for each.